

A B C D E F G

H I J K L M N O

P Q R S T U V

W X Y Z

a b c d e f g h i j l

m n o p q r s t u

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ΑΒΓΔΕΖΗΘ
ΙΚΛΜΝΞΟΠ
ΡΣΤΥΦΧΨΩ

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κλμνξοπρσ
ςτυφχψω

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Η Σεμέλη ήταν μία από τις τέσσερεις κόρες του Κάδμου, ιδρυτή και βασιλέα της Θήβας, και της Αρμονίας, κόρης της Αφροδίτης και του Άρη. Ήταν μητέρα του Διόνυσου, *ο οποίος ήταν ο καρπός της συνεύρεσής της με τον Δία*.

Όταν η Ήρα έμαθε ότι ο Δίας είχε συνευρεθεί με τη Σεμέλη εξοργίσθηκε και αποφάσισε να την φονεύσει. Έτσι εμφανίσθηκε σε αυτήν με τη μορφή μίας υπηρέτριάς της και την παρότρυνε, *δολίως, να ζητήσει από το Δία να εμφανιστεί έμπροσθέν της με τη θεϊκή του μορφή, όπως εμφανίζεται στην Ήρα και όχι με την ανθρώπινη όπως γινόταν μέχρι τότε*.

Η αφελής και υπερφίαλη Σεμέλη του το ζήτησε, αφού πρώτα τον ανάγκασε να δεσμευθεί, με τον μεγάλο όρκο της Στυγός, ότι θα ικανοποιήσει μία επιθυμία της. *Οπότε, αναγκαστικά ο Δίας πραγματοποίησε την επιθυμία της, προκαλώντας εκτυφλωτικό φως και κεραυνούς οι οποίοι τη σκότωσαν*. Μετά τον θάνατό της ο Ζεύς εξήγαγε το έμβρυο από την μήτρα της και τον εμφύτευσε στον μηρό του για να τρέφεται από το αίμα του ώσπου να γεννηθεί. Έτσι σώθηκε ο Διόνυσος.

Meaning unknown, possibly of Phrygian origin. In Greek mythology she was one of the many lovers of Zeus. *Hera, being jealous, tricked Semele into asking Zeus to display himself in all his splendour as the god of thunder*. When he did, Semele was struck by lightning and died, but not before giving birth to Dionysos.

Some are famous for their remarkable lives, others for their remarkable deaths. Little is known about Semele's life except that Zeus loved her. But she, forgetting her mortal condition, wished to see him in the same guise as when he meets Hera, and when the god showed himself she perished. *For this extraordinary way of dying, she is well known worldwide. Later, through the love of her son, she was brought up from the Underworld and made immortal, which is not less remarkable*. And these things are so curious, odd, exceptional, strange and surprising, that practically no one expects to ever witness nothing like them.

Cadmus¹ and his daughters were both fortunate and unfortunate. For he was a great king and a learned one, *having invented the alphabet and other useful things*, but on the other hand he spent his last years in exile and was also turned into a serpent, which is the punishment he received for having enjoyed the glory of killing one. Yet he was sent to the Elysian Fields after his death.

¹ Cadmus, or Kadmos (Greek: Κάδμος), in Greek mythology, was a Phoenician prince, son of Agenor and the brother of Phoenix, Cilix and Europa. Cadmus founded the Greek city of Thebes, and its acropolis was originally named Cadmeia in his honor. Though Cadmus' role in the founding myth of Thebes sets him in the Mycenaean age, the alphabet arrived in Greece centuries afterwards, during the eighth century; nevertheless, *Cadmus was credited by the Hellenes of Classical times with the introduction of the Phoenician alphabet, phoinikeia grammata*. Herodotus who gives this account estimates that Cadmus lived sixteen hundred years before his time, or around 2000 BC.

According to Greek myth, Cadmus' descendants ruled at Thebes on-and-off for several generations, *including the time of the Trojan War*. For a discussion of the mythical kings of Thebes, see Theban kings.